

The Dhāraṇī Called 'The Vajra That Utterly Destroys'

Vajravidāraṇā-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 750 · Derge Kangyur

རྡོ་རྗེ་པར་འཇམས་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའཁི་ཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī Called "The Vajra That Utterly Destroys," known in Sanskrit as the Vajravidāraṇā-nāma-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Dorje Nampar Jompa Zhejawa Zung, is a dhāraṇī text centered on the fierce and protective power of Vajrapāṇi, the bodhisattva who wields the vajra. The text presents a sacred mantra and its associated teaching, arising from Vajrapāṇi's entry into a wrathful vajra samādhi at Vajrāsana through the blessing of the buddhas and bodhisattvas, with the dhāraṇī itself described as an unconquerable force. It belongs to the dhāraṇī genre of canonical literature, which preserves potent ritual formulas alongside narrative framing that explains their origin and efficacy. This text is Toh 750 in the Kangyur, where it is classified among the dhāraṇī collections.

"I shall become so," I pledged. And if one recites it a hundred thousand times more, one will become an ācārya. The eighth name of Vajrapāṇi, together with its secret mantra, is complete.

In the language of India: Vajravidāraṇā-nāma-dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī Called "The Vajra That Utterly Destroys."

I bow to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at Vajrāsana. By the power of the buddhas, Vajrapāṇi blessed his entire body into vajra and entered the meditative absorption of the vajra samādhi. Then Vajrapāṇi, through the power of the buddhas, the blessing of the buddhas, and the blessing of all the bodhisattvas, spoke aloud from vajra-essence, arisen from the wrathful vajra:

"This is that which cannot be overpowered, cannot be cut, cannot be destroyed; that which is true, solid, and firm; that which is unobstructed everywhere; that which is undefeated everywhere; that which terrifies all sentient beings; that which stupefies all sentient beings; that which cuts through all vidyā-mantras; that which suppresses all vidyā-mantras; that which destroys all karmic workings; that which ruins all the karmic workings of others; that which annihilates all harmful spirits; that which liberates from all harmful spirits; that which summons all elemental beings; that which utterly vanquishes all elemental beings; that which sets all the activities of

vidyā-mantras into motion; that which accomplishes what has not yet been accomplished; that which prevents what has been accomplished from being wasted; that which bestows all desires; that which protects all sentient beings; that which pacifies, that which enriches; that which exhilarates all sentient beings; that which causes them to swoon — this great power of the secret mantra was thus proclaimed by Vajrapāṇi through the power of the buddhas."

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the wrathful Vajrapāṇi, great yakṣa (yakṣa) general. Thus: Oṃ truṭa truṭa, troṭaya troṭaya, sphuṭa sphuṭa, sphoṭaya sphoṭaya, ghūrṇa ghūrṇa, ghūrṇapaya ghūrṇapaya, sarva-sattvāni, bodhaya bodhaya, saṃbodhaya saṃbodhaya, bhrama bhrama, saṃbhrāmaya saṃbhrāmaya, sarva-bhūtāni, kuṭa kuṭa, saṃkuṭaya saṃkuṭaya, sarva-śatrūn, ghaṭa ghaṭa, saṃghaṭaya saṃghaṭaya, sarva-vidyā vajra vajra, sphoṭaya vajra vajra, kaṭa vajra vajra, maṭa vajra vajra, matha vajra vajra, aṭṭahāsanīla-vajra, su-vajrāya svāhā. He phullu, niruphullu, nigṛhṇa kullu, militullu, kuru kullu, vajra-vijayāya svāhā, kīli-kīlāya svāhā. Kaṭa kaṭa, maṭa maṭa, raṭa raṭa, moṭana-pramoṭanāya svāhā. Caraṇi cara, hara hara, sara sara, mārāya, vajra-vidārāya svāhā. Chinda chinda, bhinda bhinda, mahā-kīli-kīlāya svāhā. Bandha bandha, krodha krodha, kīli-kīlāya svāhā. Curu curu caṇḍala-kīli-kīlāya svāhā. Trāsaya trāsaya, vajra-kīli-kīlāya svāhā. Hara hara vajra-dharāya svāhā. Prahara prahara, vajra-prabhañjanāya svāhā. Mati-sthira-vajra, śruti-sthira-vajra, prati-sthira-vajra, mahā-vajra, apratihata-vajra, amogha-vajra, ehi-vajra, śīghraṃ vajrāya svāhā. Dhara dhara, dhiri dhiri, dhuru dhuru, sarva-vajra-kula-māvartaya svāhā. Amukaṃ mārāya phaṭ. Namaḥ samanta-vajrāṇāṃ, sarva-balaṃ āvartaya, mahā-bale, kaṭave, tatale, acale, maṇḍala-māye, ati-vajra, mahā-bale, vegāraṇa, ajite, jvala jvala, tiṭi tiṭi, tiṅgale, daha daha, tejovati, tili tili, bandha bandha, mahā-bale, vajrāṅkuśa-jvalaya svāhā.

Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the wrathful Vajrapāṇi, great yakṣa general. Thus: Oṃ hara hara vajra, matha matha vajra, dhuna dhuna vajra, daha daha vajra, paca paca vajra, dhara dhara vajra, dhārāya dhārāya vajra, dāruṇa dāruṇa vajra, chinda chinda vajra, bhinda bhinda vajra, hūṃ phaṭ.

Namaḥ Caṇḍa-vajra-krodhāya. Hulu hulu. Tiṣṭha tiṣṭha. Bandha bandha. Hana hana. Amṛte hūṃ phaṭ.

Having purified all misdeeds,
it removes all suffering entirely.
It is the very root of all tantras,

and is beautifully adorned with every splendor.

For sentient beings whose faculties are impaired,
whose life-force is exhausted or diminished,
who are afflicted by inauspicious circumstances,
who have been turned away by the gods,
who are hated by those dear to them,
who are afflicted by servants and the like,
who are in mutual discord,
who are harmed by loss of wealth,
who are harmed by grief and weariness,
who are beset by fear and by destitution,
who are struck by malefic planets, stars, and curses,
and who are threatened by intractable spirits —

even if one has seen evil dreams arising from grief and weariness, by this one is thoroughly cleansed and made pure.

One should listen to this sublime sūtra. Those who, with a virtuous and tranquil mind, adorned with clean garments, listen to this sūtra — the profound domain of the buddhas — let them know that by the splendor of this sūtra, all unbearable illnesses of every living creature shall be pacified entirely. Life and merit shall increase, and one shall be completely liberated from all misdeeds.

Gems, white mustard seed, dūrvā grass, flawless precious substances, sandalwood, crystal, vajra-flowers, and water — or, if one prefers, a silver vase — fill and bind it up with clean cloth. Then, having recited the Vajravidaraṇa dhāraṇī twenty-one times, or alternatively one hundred and eight times, the sovereign should always perform the ablution.

This concludes the dhāraṇī called Vajravidaraṇā, the Vajra that Utterly Vanquishes.

Translated by the Indian paṇḍitas Jinamitra and Dānaśīla, together with the Tibetan translator, the monk Ye shes sde, who rendered, revised, and established the final text.

Translator's Notes

- The opening sentence ("I shall become so ... I pledged ... one will become an ācārya") is a colophon fragment from a preceding section on Vajrapāṇi's eight names, and the text then transitions directly into a new text: the Vajravidāraṇā-dhāraṇī. The mantra syllables throughout

are transliterated directly from the Tibetan rendering of Sanskrit phonemes and are reproduced as standardized Sanskrit rather than retranslated, as is conventional for dhāraṇī texts. The phrase rendered "vajra-essence, arisen from the wrathful vajra" translates rdo rje khro bo las byung ba rdo rje snying pos, which can also be read as a name or epithet: "Vajrahṛdaya, arisen from the Wrathful Vajra." The reading adopted here is consistent with the dhāraṇī literature's style of describing the origin of mantra utterances.

- The term rendered "vajra-flowers" follows the compound བཞུག་ཁྲ་མཚན་ལྷ་མོ་, which could refer to a specific ritual flower associated with the vajra, or simply flowers used in a vajra-ritual context; the precise botanical or ritual referent is uncertain but the translation reflects the literal compound.

The verse section beginning "Having purified all misdeeds" reads as a condensed praise of the dhāraṇī; it is not entirely clear whether the lines describe the dhāraṇī itself or the practitioner's state after its use, but the dominant reading in this genre treats them as praise of the dhāraṇī's effects, which this translation follows.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.